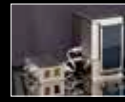


From the labs

We take a look at how the world aims to bring on the pain but not the reaper

**3D Printing in Space**

Behold the first 3D printer to have been used in space. First object to be created was a wrench. <http://dgit.in/3DPrSpace>

Orion:

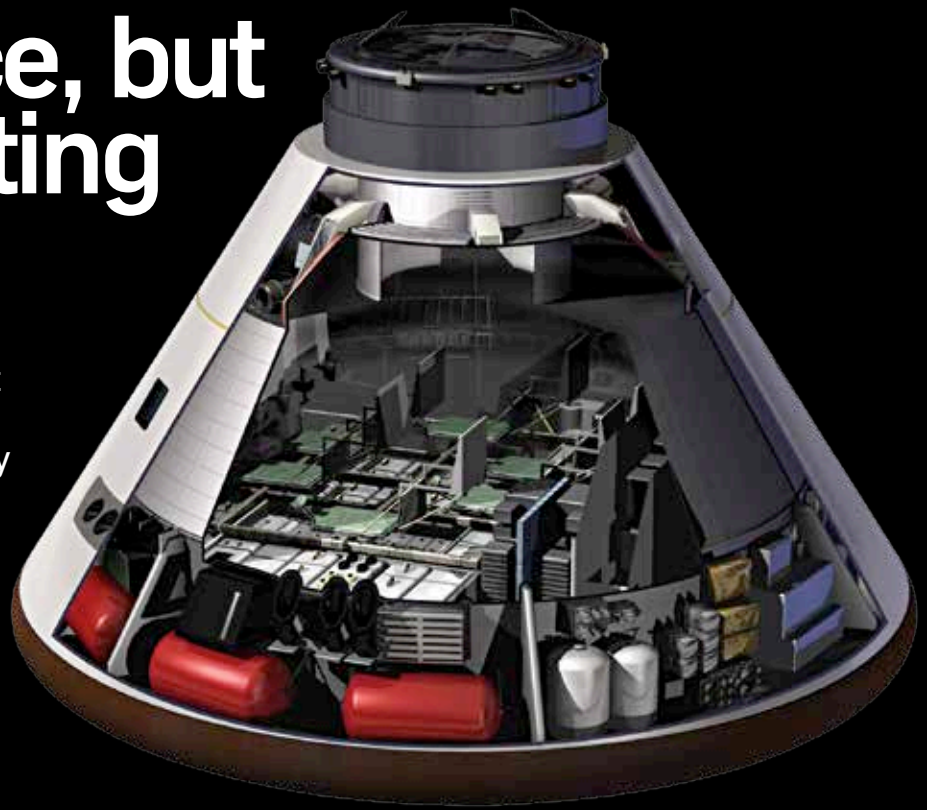
Not quite Endurance, but we're getting there

All you wanted to know about our first foray into non-terra realms, making interplanetary travel a reality

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If we just had to create a spaceship that can take us to realms far beyond the Earth, and let's not kid ourselves – Interstellar made it clear that it is indeed necessary, then we simply could not have picked out a better name than Orion. A great hunter in Greek mythology, Orion was a force to be reckoned with. It was said that he could go into unknown surroundings and conquer them to gain supremacy. A force so well respected, Zeus himself placed him among the stars on his demise (incidentally, that came after mother Earth was angered by his vanity, but that's a story for another time). Yeah, pretty much all the good qualities that you'd want from a machine that is supposed to help us set foot on new terrains.

Alright, with that seal of approval for its name, let us consider what exactly this means for mankind, and our future in the stars.



NASA's official release of Orion's cross-section

What took us so long?

Whether or not most people like to admit it, the greatest advances in space-tech came when USA and USSR went head to head in the space race, considering it to be another lap in the race for global supremacy. Of course, after the United States won that race, things kind of slowed down on that front. The spirit of competition is probably the most powerful motivator in the world, as evidenced by humanity's innovation (or lack, thereof) for the final frontier. Until recently, that is. In the month of December 2014, NASA announced that they will be putting humans

on Mars for the conclusion of their latest series of space missions – Orion.

Orion's Significance

Orion is one of the most extravagant displays of human curiosity. After sustained criticism of our neglect of one of the most interesting domains of existence, space research has really kicked into a higher gear in the past decade. They say the greatest advances in science are evolutionary and not revolutionary. And Orion, marking our first step in our quest to move beyond the limitations of the Earth, is indeed a great increment as we chart our way to con-

